



Prepared By learnwithbhawana

FIRST-TIMER WALKTHROUGH

Install Python. Open JupyterLab. Write your first code.

A screenshot-style, step-by-step guide for Windows, macOS, and Linux.

1. Download

Anaconda Distribution

2. Install

Python + Navigator

3. Launch

JupyterLab

4. Run

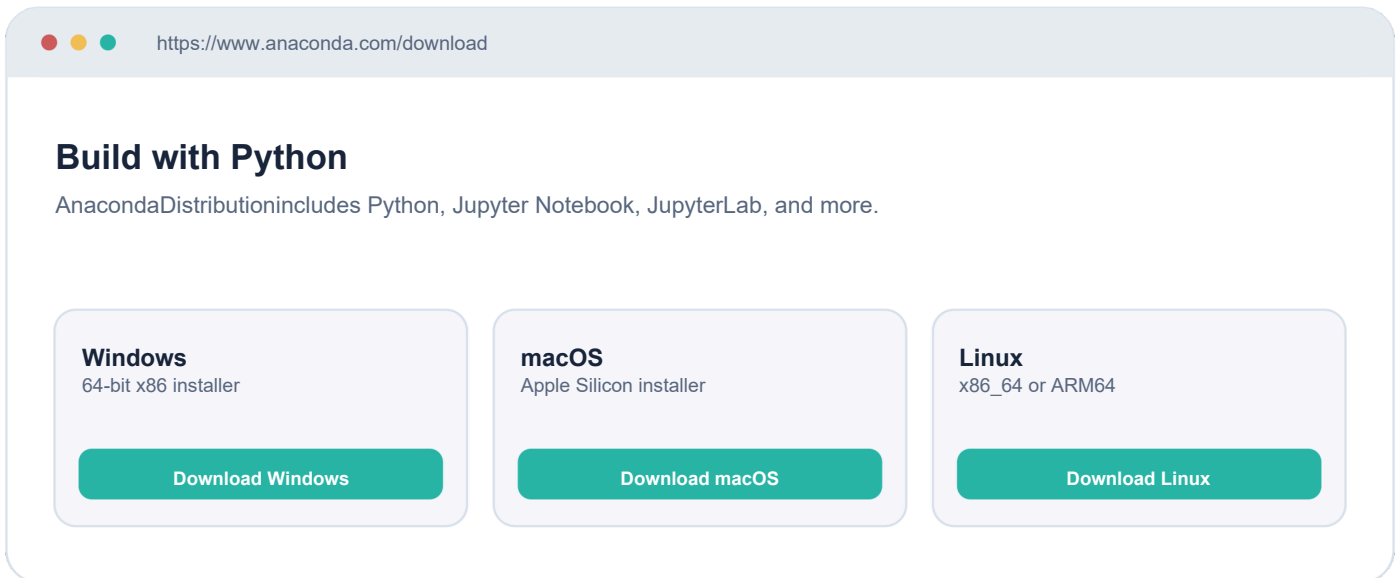
Your first cell

This uses Anaconda Distribution, which includes Python, Anaconda Navigator, and Jupyter tools. Navigator is the visual app launcher; JupyterLab is where you write and run notebook code.

SCREEN IMAGES: The UI panels in this PDF are recreated visual guides, not live screenshots. Use the labels and steps if your installed version looks a little different.

1. Choose the right download

Download Anaconda Distribution from the official site. It bundles Python and JupyterLab; Navigator gives you buttons to launch them without using commands.



Illustrative screen view, recreated for this guide. Button names and layout can differ by release.

1

Windows

Choose Windows 64-bit (x86_64) .exe. Most Windows laptops use this. Anaconda Distribution does not currently list a Windows ARM64 installer; check the download page if your laptop uses ARM.

2

Mac with M-series chip

Choose macOS Apple Silicon (arm64). Check Apple menu > About This Mac to see your chip.

3

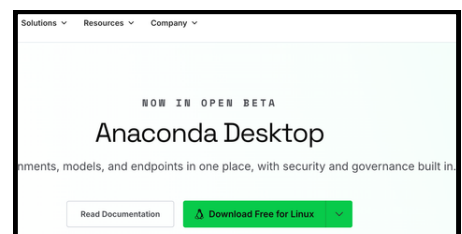
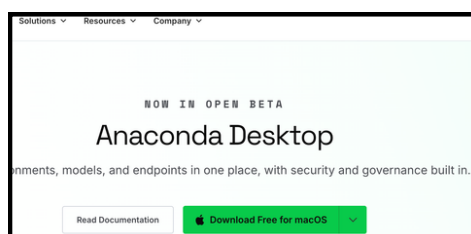
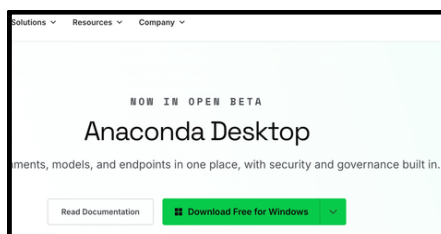
Mac with Intel chip

Anaconda ended new Intel Mac package builds in 2025. Check current support/download options before installing; do not select Apple Silicon for an Intel Mac.

4

Linux

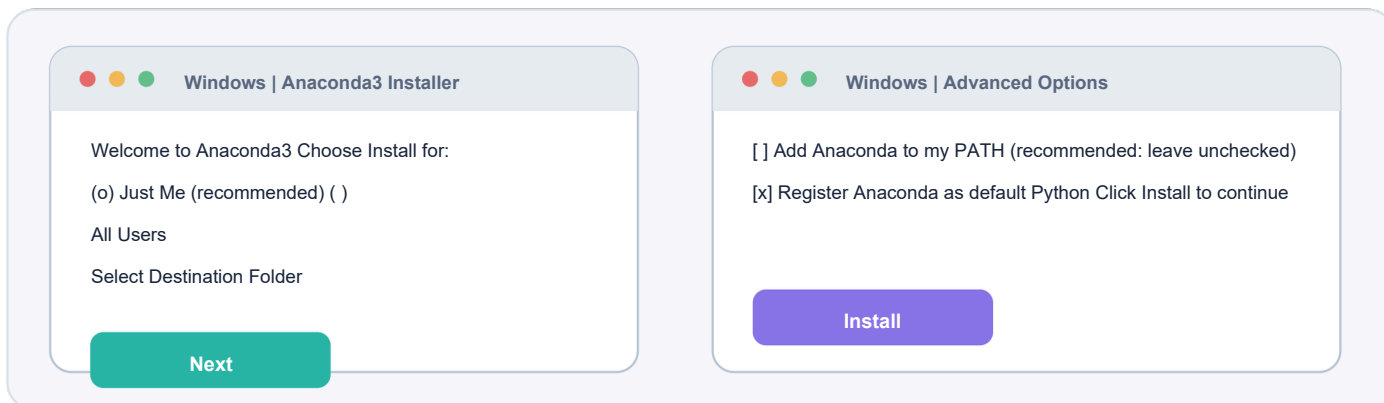
Choose Linux x86_64 for most Intel/AMD PCs; choose Linux aarch64 only for ARM64 devices.



Tip: Keep the installer in your Downloads folder until setup is complete. Use only the official Anaconda download page.

2. Install on Windows

Use GUI installer → Keep defaults: User-only + default path.



Illustrative screen view, recreated for this guide. Button names and layout can differ by release.

1

Open the downloaded .exe

In Downloads, double-click the Anaconda3 Windows installer.

2

Follow the installer

Choose Next, accept the license, and select Just Me unless your device administrator tells you otherwise.

3

Keep the defaults

Use the suggested install folder. Leave “Add Anaconda to PATH” unchecked; this avoids conflicts. If prompted, registering as the default Python is usually fine for a first Python install.

4

Finish and open Navigator

Click Install, then Finish. Search the Start menu for “Anaconda Navigator” and open it.

5

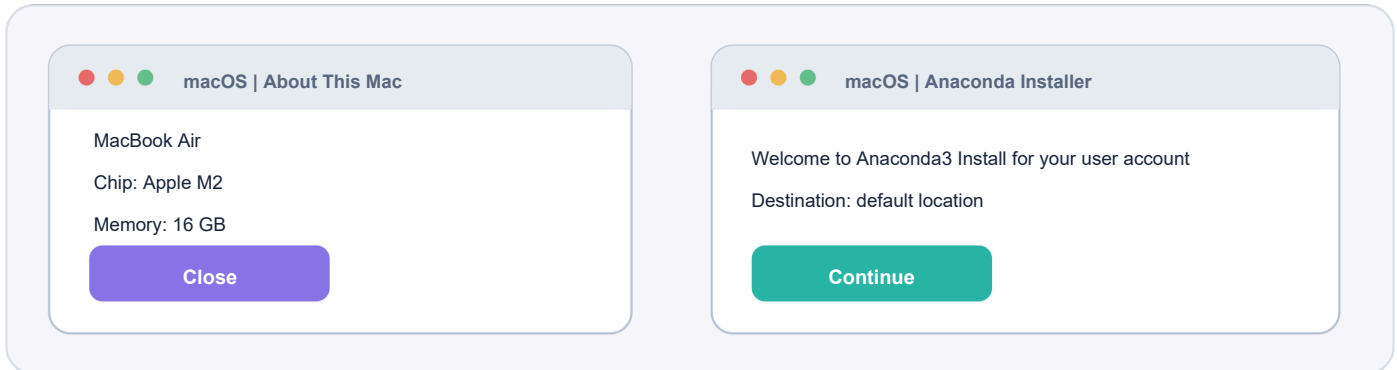
Launch JupyterLab

In Navigator Home, find JupyterLab. Click Launch. If the tile says Install, click Install first, then Launch.

If Windows asks whether to allow the app to make changes, confirm only if the publisher is Anaconda, Inc. If this is a work/school laptop, follow its software policy.

3. Install on macOS

First check the chip: Apple menu > About This Mac. M-series Macs use Apple Silicon installers. Intel Macs need a matching Intel-compatible option; support for Intel packages has been deprecated.



Illustrative screen view, recreated for this guide. Button names and layout can differ by release.

1

Check your Mac chip

Apple menu > About This Mac. Note whether it says Apple M1/M2/M3/M4 or Intel.

2

Download the matching installer

From anaconda.com/download, choose Anaconda Distribution for macOS. Select Apple Silicon for M-series Macs. For Intel Macs, verify a compatible option and package availability before proceeding.

3

Open the .pkg installer

Open Downloads, double-click the .pkg file, then follow Continue, Agree, and Install. Keep the default install choices.

4

Open Anaconda Navigator

Use Finder > Applications or Spotlight search (Command + Space), type “Anaconda Navigator,” and open it.

5

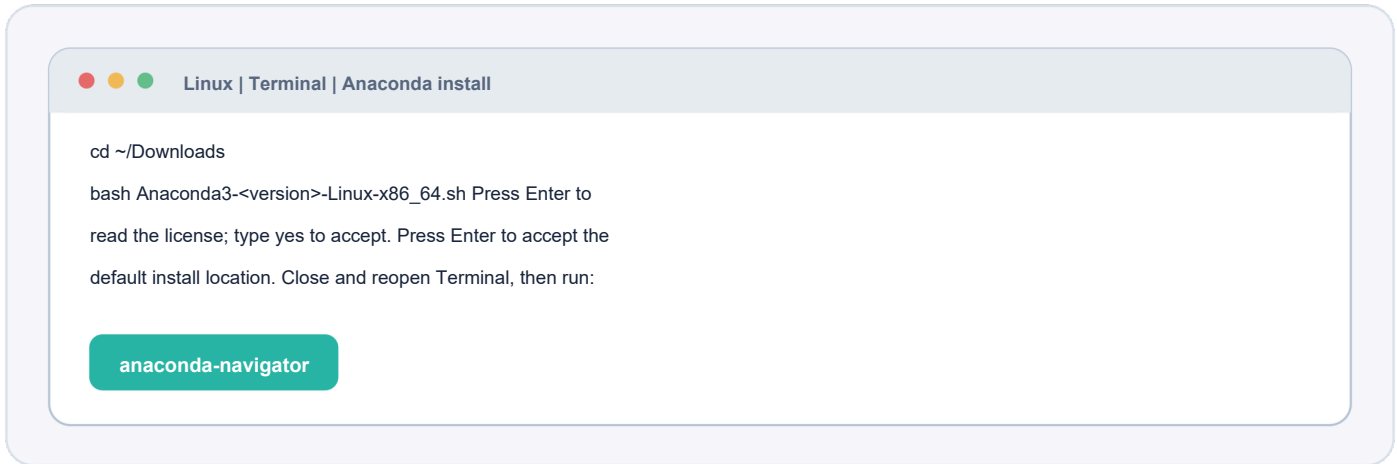
Launch JupyterLab

On Navigator Home, click Launch under JupyterLab. If it is not installed, click Install first.

Important for Intel Macs: Anaconda stopped building new Intel Mac packages in August 2025. The software may still be available, but future package support differs from Apple Silicon. See Anaconda's Intel Mac notice.

4. Install on Linux

Linux uses a shell-script installer. This walkthrough assumes a normal desktop Linux account and the default bash shell. No administrator command is needed for a user-level install.



Illustrative screen view, recreated for this guide. Button names and layout can differ by release.

1

Choose the Linux installer

Download the .sh installer for Linux x86_64 for most Intel/AMD laptops. Choose AARCH64 only if your Linux device uses ARM64.

2

Open Terminal in Downloads

Open Terminal from your apps. Type: `cd ~/Downloads` and press Enter.

3

Run the installer

Type `bash Anaconda3--Linux-x86_64.sh`, replacing the filename with the exact downloaded name. Press Enter.

4

Answer the prompts

Press Enter to read the license. Type yes when asked to accept. Press Enter to use the suggested location. If asked to initialize conda, type yes.

5

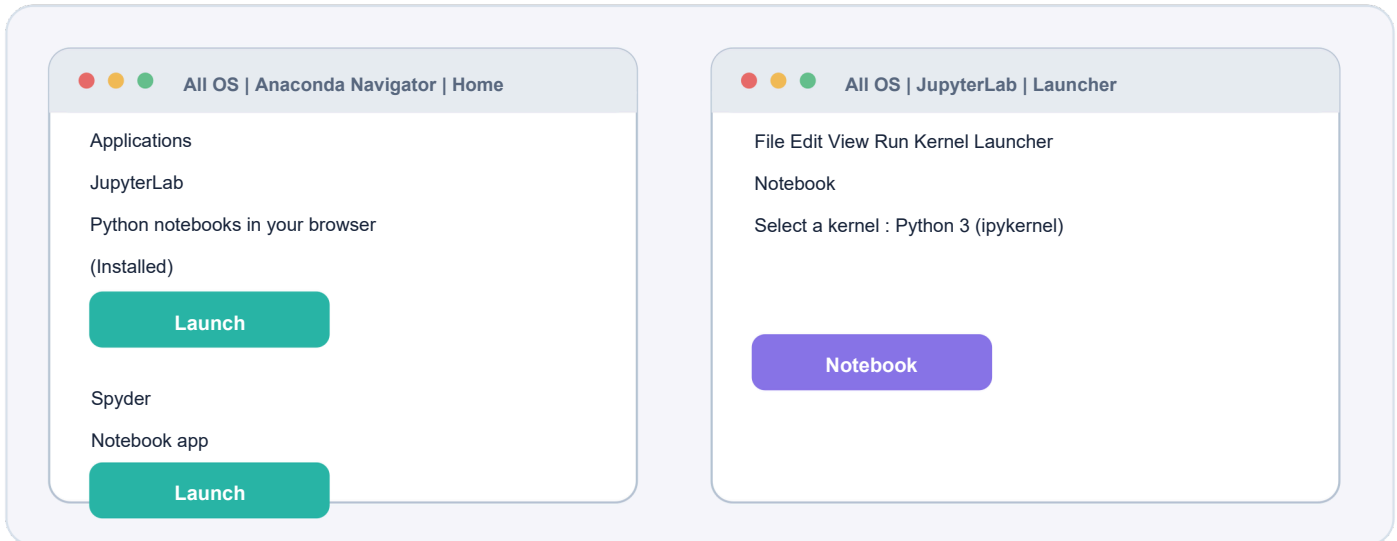
Open Navigator

Close and reopen Terminal, then type `anaconda-navigator`. In Navigator, click Launch under JupyterLab.

Linux filename tip: your download will contain the exact release number. Copy the actual filename from Downloads; do not type the angle-bracket placeholder.

5. Open JupyterLab and create a notebook

Once Anaconda Navigator is open, the next screens are almost the same on Windows, macOS, and Linux.



Illustrative screen view, recreated for this guide. Button names and layout can differ by release.

1

In Navigator

On the Home tab, find the JupyterLab tile. Choose the environment that shows Python 3 (usually base) if a selector appears.

2

Click Launch

If the button says Install, click it and wait for installation to finish. Then click Launch.

3

In JupyterLab

A browser tab opens. On the Launcher, click Notebook under the Notebook section. Select Python 3 (ipykernel) if asked.

4

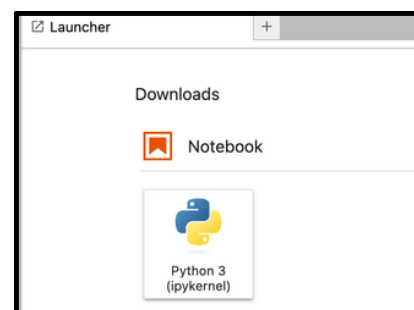
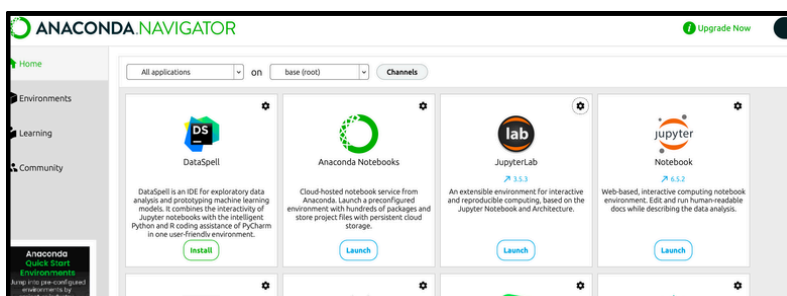
Type and run code

Click the first blank cell. Type `print("Hello, Python!")` and press Shift + Enter.

5

Save your notebook

Use File>Save Notebook As. Give it a clear name, such as `python_practice.ipynb`.



YOUR FIRST CELL

```
print("Hello, Python!")
Hello, Python!
```

Quick fixes for common first-time issues

Navigator is missing

Search your computer for Anaconda Navigator. If it doesn't show up, the installation may not have finished. Re-run the installer you downloaded from Anaconda.

JupyterLab tile says Install

That is normal when JupyterLab is not installed in the selected environment. Click Install, wait for it to finish, then click Launch.

Browser opened but page is loading

Wait a moment. Keep the terminal or Navigator window open while JupyterLab starts - it runs locally and will open in your browser.

No Python 3 kernel appears

In Navigator, use the default base (anaconda) environment, or install / repair Python and JupyterLab from inside Navigator.

Permission or school/work device issue

Do not bypass your device controls. Ask your IT administrator to approve the installer or use the Python environment they recommend.

Mac says installer cannot be opened

Confirm it came from the official Anaconda download page. Check macOS Privacy & Security settings and follow Apple's standard steps to open the app.

Linux command says file not found

Check the spelling and capitalization. Use the exact installer filename from your Downloads folder and make sure you're in that folder by running ``ls``.

You can learn Python in an online notebook too. Local installation is useful when you want a workspace on your own laptop.

Official references

Use these pages if the download screen or app labels have changed. The guide's screen illustrations show the main controls; check the current official page before downloading.

Anaconda Distribution download

<https://www.anaconda.com/download>

Current installer choices; includes Python, Jupyter Notebook, and JupyterLab.

Anaconda Navigator

<https://www.anaconda.com/products/navigator>

Navigator launches applications and manages packages/environments without the command line.

Anaconda Intel Mac package notice

<https://www.anaconda.com/blog/intel-mac-package-support-deprecation>

Intel Mac package build support was deprecated effective August 15, 2025.

JupyterLab: Starting JupyterLab

https://jupyterlab.readthedocs.io/en/stable/getting_started/starting.html

Explains that JupyterLab opens in a browser and how to start it.

Anaconda: First steps with Python

<https://www.anaconda.com/blog/anaconda-python-complete-beginners-guide>

Beginner guide for installing Anaconda, launching Navigator, and starting Jupyter.

Screenshots and platform differences

The interface panels in this guide are recreated illustrations for learning, not direct screenshots from installed Windows, macOS, or Linux systems. Installer wording can vary by release. Anaconda Distribution is a large download, so use a stable connection and allow time for installation.